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What Do You Want to Be When You Grow Up?

If you don't know where you're going,
any road will take you there.

—*Alice in Wonderland*

In Chapter 2, we learned that there are only two ways to make your financial situation better, make more money or spend less. If you can't possibly cut down your expenses any further, you may want to concentrate on ways to increase your income. To clarify what defines income, it is money you have received free and clear or earned but not borrowed. Don't make the mistake of believing that credit (see Chapter 3) is an extension of your available income.

In 2005, teens (twelve through nineteen years old) had a combined income of \$159 billion, according to Teenage Research Unlimited. Teens obtained their money from a variety of sources:

- From parents when needed
- Odd jobs
- Gifts
- Regular allowance
- Full-time jobs
- Part-time jobs